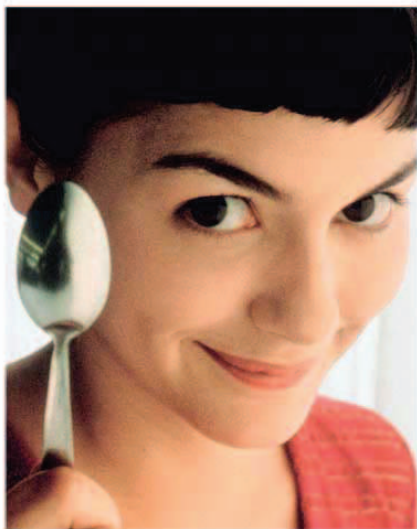




I LIKE TO LOOK FOR THINGS NO-ONE ELSE CATCHES

AMÉLIE / 2001

IN CONTEXT

GENRE

Romantic comedy

DIRECTOR

Jean-Pierre Jeunet

WRITERS

**Guillaume Laurant,
Jean-Pierre Jeunet**

STARS

**Audrey Tautou, Mathieu
Kassovitz, Dominique Pinon**

BEFORE

1991 Jeunet and Marc Caro's *Delicatessen* is an inventive fantasy movie set in a postapocalyptic France.

1995 The baroque fairy tale *The City of Lost Children* gets Jeunet noticed by Hollywood.

AFTER

2004 Jeunet teams up with Tautou for the war drama *A Very Long Engagement*.

2009 *Micmacs* is a comedy-satire by Jeunet about the arms industry.

After enjoying critical success in France, Jean-Pierre Jeunet's first venture into Hollywood was a troubled one. Hired to direct the fourth movie in the science-fiction *Alien* series, the project suffered production difficulties and was released to mixed

reviews. Jeunet returned to France discouraged, and for his next movie concocted *Amélie*, a work in which every frame seems to celebrate a freedom that had perhaps been denied to him on his previous project. Structurally, *Amélie* is a romantic comedy—the story of



In *Amélie*, Jeunet succeeded in finding a new take on the tired and much-derided romantic comedy genre, using an ambitious pairing of style and subject matter.

a waitress meeting the man she's

destined to fall in love with; in practice the movie is a tribute to a virtuoso creativity and imagination. Despite the smallness of the central story, Jeunet uses techniques usually reserved for action movies and epics. The far-reaching and expansive script, the strong use of color, and the experimental editing



Jean-Pierre Jeunet Director

Jean-Pierre Jeunet was born in the Loire region, France, in 1953.

He bought his first movie camera at 17 when he studied animation at Cinéma studios. His first feature movie was *Delicatessen*, which he codirected with Marc Caro. Based on the commercial and critical success of their

follow-up, *The City of Lost Children*, Jeunet was offered *Alien: Resurrection*. After it performed poorly, he returned to France and directed *Amélie*, his most celebrated movie.

Key movies

1991 *Delicatessen*
1995 *The City of Lost Children*
2001 *Amélie*